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HOW TO COPE WITH  
THE DEPARTURE OF  
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AFP

## HUGE SUPPORT FOR UAE TOUR CYCLING RACE

Riders start the fourth stage of the UAE Tour cycling race from Fujairah Qidfa Beach to Umm Al Quwain in the UAE yesterday. Italy's Jonathan Milan prevailed in a tight sprint to claim yesterday's wind-battered fourth stage with UAE Team Emirates' Tadej Pogacar retaining the leader's red jersey. Pogacar, who won Wednesday's third stage, remained in command of the general classification after the 181km ride.

## UAE launches price monitoring platform

Authorities to track  
prices of nine essential  
consumer goods

DUBAI

BY KHITAM AL AMIR  
Chief News Editor

The Ministry of Economy has launched the National Commodity Price Control Platform, a new digital tool designed to enhance government surveillance of market pricing and provide real-time tracking of essential goods.

The platform, which was developed in response to the growing need for more robust market oversight, also aims to

to stabilise prices and protect consumers from unjust price hikes.

### Consumer protection

It will allow competent authorities to monitor the prices of nine essential consumer goods — cooking oil, eggs, dairy, rice, sugar, poultry, legumes, bread, and wheat — across the nation's largest retail outlets, including cooperatives, hypermarkets, and major stores. The monitoring covers more than 90 per cent of the UAE's domestic trade in these basic commodities.

According to Abdullah Bin Touq Al Marri, Minister of Economy, the launch of this

platform will reinforce the UAE's commitment to consumer protection and market stability. "The UAE has established an integrated legislative and regulatory framework to safeguard consumers, ensuring a safe and stable environment for shopping while boosting the retail and wholesale sectors," said Al Marri.

The platform instantly tracks pricing fluctuations and compares them against a pre-established price ceiling set by the government. This feature ensures compliance with the official pricing policy, helping prevent price manipulation, unjust hikes, or market exploitation by traders or suppliers.

# UAE in top 10 of Global Soft Power Index

COUNTRY RANKS 8TH IN INFLUENCE, 9TH IN GLOBAL DIPLOMATIC CIRCLES

DUBAI

BY KHITAM AL AMIR  
Chief News Editor

The UAE has secured 10th place globally in the Global Soft Power Index 2025. The UAE's Nation Brand also witnessed a significant increase in its value from \$1 trillion to \$1.223 trillion in 2025.

The Global Soft Power Index, published by Brand Finance, evaluates 193 countries based on insights from 173,000 business leaders, policymakers, and civil society figures, making it one of the most comprehensive assessments of national influence and perception.

The UAE was among the top 10 globally in key categories, ranking 4th in 'Future Growth Potential', 4th in 'Generous', 7th in 'A strong and stable economy', 8th in 'Influence', 9th in 'International Relations', 9th in 'Influential in diplomatic circles', 9th 'Advanced technology and innovation', 10th in 'Investment in Space Exploration', and 10th in 'Affairs I follow closely'.

### Trusted global partner

His Highness Shaikh Mohammed Bin Rashid Al Maktoum, Vice-President and Prime Minister of the UAE and Ruler of Dubai, affirmed that under the leadership of President His Highness Shaikh Mohammed Bin Zayed Al Nahyan,

2<sup>nd</sup>

UAE's global rank  
for being easy to do  
business in and with

the country has solidified its role as a trusted global partner in fostering development and stability.

He stated: "The UAE has reinforced its position among the world's most influential nations, ranking 10th globally in the 2025 Global Soft Power Index, announced today in London.

"The index, which assessed 193 countries and gathered insights from 173,000 participants, also placed the UAE 8th in 'Influence' and 9th in 'Influential in diplomatic circles', reflecting its expanding leadership and impact on global affairs."

The UAE also ranked 2nd globally in 'Ease of Doing Business', a testament to its investor-friendly policies, advanced digital infrastructure, and economic adaptability.

Among other Middle East countries, Saudi Arabia dropped two positions to 20th and Qatar fell one spot to 22nd.

The US retained the top spot, while China overtook UK for 2nd place, followed by Japan (4th), and Germany (5th).

### SPECIAL REPORT

Ismail Al Naqi:  
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agility, people  
power UAE's  
success | P10-11

### MIDDLE EAST

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meet in Riyadh  
to counter  
Trump Gaza  
plan | P13

### SPORT

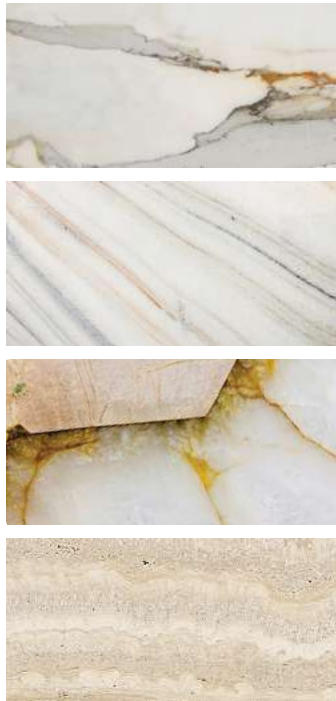
Sublime Gill  
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### WORLD

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by Putin and  
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